

where the kernel and user activities are managed. Finally, comes the firmware for the hardware. The verified boot process and system recovery reside here.

The one key feature of Chromium which sets it apart from Chrome, is that the first is supported by the community and results in all sorts of interesting and even experimental outputs. You often get bugs found in Chrome are fixed sooner in Chromium, and you also get some weird yet sometimes useful features being built for Chromium. The most popular build is supported by Arnoldthebat and it's called ChromiumOS Vanilla.

When Google decided to stop creating Chromium builds, Hexxeh started releasing his own version of the vanilla builds. He stopped in 2013 and sometime from then, Arnoldthebat picked it up and has continued.

Another commonly used build is CloudReady by Neverware. This was developed for educational market and designed to extend lives of older computers.

Nexedi's NayaOS is relatively new, but is targeted at people who dislike working within the Google ecosystem, but love the concept of cloud computers. It allows users to have Chrome OS-like capabilities without storing any data on Google's servers and removing the need for a Google login.

Chromium Build Kit, released in July 2012, automatically compiles a Chromium builds and installs it on a USB drive. This makes you create your own Chromebit-like device much more easily.

Andromeda

This is what happens when a giant publication writes about a possible existence of the fantasies of millions of people. The idea of Android and Chrome OS becoming one was something that a lot of people wanted. Microsoft and Apple were doing it, so why not Google joins the party too? It would be beneficial for all of us. An OS which seamlessly connects your smartphone to your personal computer. The only problem, Google actually never officially announced it. The concept of this new OS was only leaked by a 'source'. While the hype started dying down eventually because of the lack of confirmation or denial from Google, the fires were rekindled when Android apps were made compatible with Chrome OS. Most people believe Andromeda is actually around the corner, and is the marriage of Android and Chrome OS, and not a totally new OS as some claim.

Managing Editor of 9to5 Google, Stephen Hall tweeted that his sources tell him that the Andromeda project has been shelved for another project—the forthcoming OS Fuchsia. As of yet this new OS has only been shown to